

Forms, Workflows & Pipeline

The GHL half of the funnel, plus the architecture decision that has to land before any of it gets built.

THE DECISION TO MAKE FIRST

GHL forms embedded, or Next.js forms with a webhook?

Your instinct was GHL forms embedded into the Next.js pages. It's a reasonable call and it's genuinely faster. Here's the honest cost of it, because two of the trade-offs land directly on things you've already paid for.

	A — GHL forms, embedded	B — Next.js form, API + webhook
Build time	~2 hours	~4–6 hours
Delivery trigger	Native <code>Form submitted</code> . Nothing to wire.	Inbound Webhook fired by the route handler.
Pixel <code>Lead</code> on submit	Not possible — an iframe submit isn't observable from the parent page. Workaround: fire on thank-you page view instead.	Fires on real submit, deduped with CAPI on a shared <code>eventId</code> .
CAPI match quality	Degraded. The server never sees the email unless GHL passes it back in the redirect.	Full — hashed email, fbclid, IP, user agent.
UTM capture	Via GHL hidden fields, which means the parent has to append params to the iframe src. Known fragile point.	Captured client-side, first-touch, persisted. Reliable.
Brand + a11y control	Limited. Form markup is GHL's, so the measured a11y 100 is at risk on all three pages.	Total. Keeps the locked contrast, focus and 44pt tap rules.
Page performance	Embed script + iframe. <code>/decode</code> is already at LCP 3.1s.	No third-party weight.
Idempotency	Handled by GHL contact dedupe.	Yours to implement. Spec'd below.

Recommendation: build B, keep A as the escape hatch DECIDE WED 9AM

Two things tip it. First, the whole reason the site was built in Next.js was accurate conversion signal — and the 11thFA lesson was that broken tracking surfaces *after* launch, when spend is already running. Option A knowingly reintroduces exactly that. Second, there are two full days before Wednesday, so B's extra half-day fits comfortably.

But build the three GHL forms anyway. They're about 30 minutes, they're needed regardless for organic and link-in-bio traffic, and they become the fallback: if B hasn't passed an end-to-end test by Wednesday morning, swap the component for the embed and ship. The forms exist either way — only the toggle changes.

Put the guide download on the thank-you page, not only in the email

The sending domain is days old and Chase's forward test landed in spam. If the guide arrives by email *only*, then every dollar of ad spend on Wednesday converts into leads who may never receive the thing they asked for — and the complaint rate from people who opted in and got nothing damages the domain further.

Fix: the thank-you page shows the download button immediately. The email becomes redundancy, not the delivery mechanism. The email address is already captured before that page loads, so nothing is lost. This decouples launch entirely from deliverability, and the delivery email then goes to a warm, engaged audience — which is the best possible warming traffic. See the deliverability plan for why that matters more than it sounds.

THE THREE OPEN QUESTIONS — ANSWERED

1 Idempotency is scoped to the (email, leadMagnet) pair

Your reading was right, and the contradiction resolves that way. Implement it **in the route handler, not in a workflow**: upsert the contact, check for a `delivered-decode` / `delivered-vetbill` tag, fire the webhook and write the tag only if it's absent, and return success either way. No conflict with the workflows because nothing in them branches on those tags — and keeping the condition in code keeps an IF/ELSE out of GHL, which is where the AI builder reliably gets things backwards.

2 Consent reaches the server in the request body

Add `consent: boolean` to the documented request — yes, that's a spec change; make it. Gate both Pixel and CAPI on it, so the two never disagree. At launch: **default granted, with targeting restricted to the US**. Region detection isn't wired, so the gate can't do its job yet, and the honest mitigation is not sending EU/UK traffic at all until the banner-vs-CMP decision lands. That constraint is written into Hanzala's brief.

3 Paid non-Meta traffic gets its own enum value

Add `Paid - Other` and `Referral` to `traffic_source`. Derive it: `utm_medium` containing paid/cpc/ppc and an unrecognised source becomes `Paid - Other`; a non-search referrer with no UTMs becomes `Referral`; otherwise `Direct`. Without this, paid traffic from anywhere else silently books itself as Organic and corrupts the one comparison this taxonomy exists for.

SCHEMA

Custom fields — build these before anything else

Settings → Custom Fields. Forms can't map to fields that don't exist, and the Next.js adapter writes to these exact keys. A rename later means touching the adapter, the workflows and the reporting.

Field	Key	Type	Values / notes
Parent Audience	parent_audience	Dropdown	Pets > Dogs · Homeowners (exists, unused here)
Lead Magnet	lead_magnet	Dropdown	Decode · VetBill · Newsletter — first magnet only , see below
Interest	interest	Multi-select	dental, nutrition, training, senior, gear — set by clicks, never at capture
Traffic Source	traffic_source	Dropdown	Meta · Pinterest · Organic · Direct · Paid — Other · Referral
Campaign	campaign	Text	
UTM × 5	utm_*	Text	source, medium, campaign, content, term
Buyer State	buyer_state	Dropdown	Bought bundle · Bought single · Declined — set by workflow only
Landing Page	landing_page	Text	Which page captured them

The **pets-dogs** VS **Pets > Dogs** thing, resolved

Your progress log flagged this as a silent-break risk. It isn't one, because they're two different objects: the **field value** is **Pets > Dogs**, the **tag** is **audience-pets-dogs**. Nothing branches on the field. Keep both, spelled exactly that way.

A single-select **lead_magnet** can't hold two guides

Someone who downloads Decode this week and Vet Bill next week overwrites the field. So **lead_magnet** records the **first** magnet, for attribution, and the tags **lead-magnet-decode** / **lead-magnet-vetbill** carry the full set. The nurture workflows already trigger on the tags, so this needs no workflow change — just don't read the field to decide what someone has.

No phone field, on any form. Nothing in this funnel sends SMS, A2P isn't filed, and collecting numbers for an unusable channel creates an obligation with no payoff.

THE THREE FORMS

Form	Placement	leadMagnet	On success
Coco — Decode Opt-in	/decode	decode	Redirect to /decode/thank-you
Coco — Vet Bill Opt-in	/vetbill	vetbill	Redirect to /vetbill/thank-you
Coco — Newsletter	Home, InboxPreview	newsletter	Inline success. No redirect, no guide language.

One visible field: email

No name, no phone. Required input attributes — these cost real completions on mobile if skipped:

```
type="email" inputmode="email"
autocomplete="email" enterkeyhint="go"
autocapitalize="off" autocorrect="off"
spellcheck="false"
```

Form settings (path A only)

Sticky contact — On

On submit — Redirect to URL, not "show message". The thank-you page carries the download and the offer.

Field validation — On

Facebook Pixel ID — **leave blank**. Pixel is wired at page level; setting it here too double-counts leads and corrupts the optimisation signal.

Consent copy — compliance-relevant, don't rewrite for punchiness

Beneath the field, visible before submit, not in a tooltip: *"Free guide, straight to your inbox. Coco sends a few useful emails after — unsubscribe any time."*

No pre-ticked box, no separate consent checkbox — submit plus visible disclosure is the permission. It has to keep honestly disclosing that ongoing marketing email follows the free guide. No double opt-in: it costs 20–40% of the list and the delivery email is itself an engagement signal.

AUTOMATION

Workflows

Seven workflows, deliberately simple. Separate workflows per concept instead of one branched workflow, because a reversed IF/ELSE here means sending someone the wrong guide — visible to the subscriber, immediately.

Workflow	Trigger	What it does
WF-4 Hygiene	Unsub / bounce / complaint	Immediate hard suppression that overrides everything else. Build this first — it can't be retrofitted after a complaint.
WF-1a Decode delivery	Inbound Webhook	Tag, deliver hosted PDF URL, add to pipeline. No waits, no branches.
WF-1b Vet Bill delivery	Inbound Webhook	Same, plus the <i>"general guidance, not veterinary care"</i> line in the email.
WF-1c Newsletter	Inbound Webhook	Tag + welcome only. No PDF, no Day 0–5 nurture, no pipeline.
WF-2a Decode nurture	Tag <code>lead-magnet-decode</code>	Day 1 → Day 3 → Day 5, exits on <code>buyer-bundle</code> .
WF-2b Vet Bill nurture	Tag <code>lead-magnet-vetbill</code>	Same shape. Compliance lines in every email, not just the first.
WF-3 / 3b Buyer split	Order form / tag	Blocked on Chase's price. Don't build against an unlocked number.

Why Inbound Webhook and not `Contact Created`

An API contact upsert does not fire GH's `Form submitted` trigger, so under path B that trigger is simply dead. But `Contact Created` is also wrong, and more subtly: someone who already downloaded Decode is an *existing* contact, so it won't fire when they come back for Vet Bill — and they'd never receive the second guide. The webhook fires on every submission regardless. The handler therefore makes **two** calls, upsert then webhook; it's tempting to collapse them and it breaks exactly that case.

Check: waits are days

The builder flips days to hours routinely. WF-2a should span 5 days end to end, not 5 hours.

Check: WF-1c has no nurture

The builder will try to add one, because that's the pattern in the two before it. Those emails say "the guide you downloaded".

Check: WF-3b removes buyers

Reversed, it emails paying customers a reminder to buy what they own. Test by tagging declined then buyer.

VISIBILITY

Pipeline — Coco Subscriber Value

A subscriber-value pipeline, not a sales pipeline. Its job is showing how many people are stuck between stages — that's where the funnel actually leaks.

#	Stage	Enters when	Set by
1	Opted in	Submission succeeds	WF-1a / WF-1b, at start
2	Guide sent	Delivery email accepted, not bounced	WF-1a / WF-1b, after send
3	Engaged	Clicked any link — clicks only, never opens	WF-2a / WF-2b
4	Offer seen	Viewed the thank-you offer	Blocked — create empty
5	Buyer	Bundle or single purchased	Blocked on price
—	Declined → Re-offered	Reached the offer, didn't buy	Blocked on price

Three design calls

Opportunities, not contacts. An API upsert doesn't create an opportunity — the workflow's "add to pipeline" action does. Skip it and contacts land fine while the board stays empty.

One opportunity per lead magnet. Both guides means two opportunities. That's what makes the Decode-vs-VetBill comparison possible, which is the main question this project exists to answer.

Newsletter subscribers stay out. No guide, no offer — every stage past the first is meaningless for them and they'd quietly corrupt every conversion rate on the board.

Why stages 1 and 2 both exist

They look redundant since delivery is instant. The point is isolating **bounces**: anyone who never leaves stage 1 gave you a bad address, and on a brand-new sending domain that's the number you most need in front of you.

Settings: opportunity value stays 0 until Chase's price lands — a placeholder makes the revenue column confidently wrong. Don't use a "lost" stage; a non-buyer is the re-offer segment, not a loss. Leave auto-move-on-stale off, because stuck is the signal.

BLOCKERS BEFORE SPEND

Four things that stop Wednesday, in priority order

1. Vercel deployment protection is ON **HARD BLOCKER**

The preview URL redirects to a Vercel login wall. That means Chase and Hanzala can't see the site — and more seriously, **Meta's ad review crawler can't either**, which is a common cause of outright ad rejection. Ship to the production domain with protection disabled, or issue a protection-bypass link. Verify by loading the URL in a logged-out private window before handing it to anyone.

2. Vet sign-off on the call-now table **BLOCKS /vetbill ONLY**

Your own log has this as launch-blocking, and it is: the symptom categories came from a brief description rather than a clinical source, on a page whose entire job is telling people when to call a vet. **Recommendation:** **promote /decode only on Wednesday.** It has no clinical content, it's the curiosity angle, and it lets Chase have his Wednesday launch without shipping unreviewed veterinary triage guidance. Vet Bill follows once someone qualified has read it.

3. Three OG images

Currently `ready: false`, so pages ship with no share image. Every paid social share and every internal link preview renders blank. Cheap to fix, disproportionately visible.

4. Tracking verified firing

Confirm Pixel and the conversion event fire on submit *before* spend, not after. This is the precise thing that went wrong on 11thFA and only surfaced post-launch.

Build order for tomorrow

- 1 Custom fields**
All of §Schema, exact keys, including the two new `traffic_source` values. Nothing downstream works without these.
- 2 WF-4 hygiene**
Suppression live before a single send. Boring, protects everything else.
- 3 The three GHL forms + pipeline**
Forms take ~30 min and are the fallback regardless of which path wins. Pipeline stages all seven, wire 1–3.
- 4 WF-1a / 1b / 1c with Inbound Webhook triggers**
Create them, save, then copy the three webhook URLs out — they only exist after the trigger is saved, and the Next.js handler needs them as env vars.
- 5 Test the webhook payload** **DO THIS TUESDAY**
Confirm the Inbound Webhook trigger actually exposes payload fields inside the workflow. Recommended but unconfirmed on this GHL version. If it doesn't, the fallback is setting fields via the upsert and having the webhook carry only email plus concept — a one-file change behind the adapter, but only if you find out with runway left.
- 6 Next.js form + route handler**
Per the capture-forms prompt, with the three answers above folded in. Then the end-to-end test on both concepts.
- 7 WF-2a / 2b nurture**
Structure with placeholder bodies; Paul's copy swaps in. WF-3 waits for the price.

Minimum viable Wednesday

If anything slips: fields + WF-4 + WF-1a + the Decode form + the thank-you download is a complete, honest funnel. It captures an email, delivers the guide, suppresses properly and tracks the lead. Nurture, Vet Bill and the whole offer ladder can land after traffic is already running. Don't hold the launch for the parts that depend on Chase.

Leave `OfferScaffold` untouched — it's pre-existing from the site brief, not something the forms task introduces. Stripping it is a separate commit if you want it gone.